The issue of governments admitting the collaboration of their wartime predecessors with the German occupiers, their maltreatment of their Jewish citizens, or disinterest in their fate during the Holocaust are indicative of larger social characteristics. The same is true of the apologies offered by postwar governments for such misconduct. Without doubt, among the worst culprits in remaining silent about their country's collaboration with the Nazis were Dutch postwar governments. They have neither admitted nor apologized for their criminal misconduct toward Dutch Jews. The French government, too, required fifty years to officially admit to war crimes or collaboration. Toward the end of 2002, various anti-Israeli boycotts were proposed at French universities. The philosopher Bernard-Henri Lévy then wrote: "The French university is the only major institution that has not repented its mistakes under the Vichy regime. In this context the boycott by Paris 6 University seems even more shameful."[4] Ultimately, these boycotts did not materialize.

POST-MODERN SOCIETIES

In 2010, I published *The Decay: Jews in a Rudderless Netherlands*, a book in which I used the Dutch Jewish community as a prism for looking at Dutch society.[5] It illustrates that Jews have few significant roles in Dutch society, but they do serve a symbolic function, including their portrayal as "absolute victim." Jews are used from time as an instrument in Dutch politics. Interfaith dialogues that a few Jews hold with some Muslims are often promoted by politicians as a broad sign of hope for the supposed advancement and integration of Muslims within Dutch society. Other politicians mistakenly view the past integration of Dutch Jews into society as a model for the future integration of the majority of the Muslim community.[6]

The reality, however, is quite different. Multiple social problems are caused by parts of the Dutch Muslim community, which demonstrate a palpable unwillingness to integrate. If one compares this with the successful integration of the Dutch Jewish community, the many failures of parts of the Muslim community are exposed.

Another symbolic role Dutch Jews have is to be held by many as responsible for Israel's actions. This was particularly true during Israel's 2014 Protective Edge campaign. There was an unprecedented explosion of antisemitism in the Netherlands, mainly manifested in verbal threats and hate speech on the Internet.

There was also some violence. A woman was physically assaulted for displaying an Israeli flag from her balcony in east Amsterdam. She suffered a

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